

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex disputes, arbitration and litigation at BCLP, Q-Legal and Citizens Advice. Experienced in preparing hearing bundles and court materials, conducting legal and factual research, coordinating document filings, maintaining organised case files and advising clients on procedural requirements. Strong analytical and written communication skills, with a developing interest in regulatory and competition proceedings.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court materials and skeleton arguments across multiple matters
- Coordinated court filings, hearing arrangements and matter opening and closure processes
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage; tracked deadlines across competing matters
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents with accuracy and within tight timeframes

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Jan 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline, coordinating documents and tracking outstanding actions to ensure on-time filing
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Researches complex legal points across welfare, housing, employment and consumer matters; identifies evidential gaps
- Translates complex statutory requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, and identified compliance risks from the client's data processing
- Translated complex statutory requirements into commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet the submission deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed data-processing provisions and researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, court filing coordination, procedural histories, evidence review, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters